

Presentation topic

- 1.4) research problem and topic
- 1.5) characteristics of research problem

Research problem

- A research problem is exactly that a problem that someone would like to research. A problem can be anything that a person finds unsatisfactory or unsettling, a difficulty of some sort, a state of affair that needs to be changed, anything that is not working as well as it might.
- problems involves areas of concern to researchers, condition they want to improve, difficulties they want to eliminate, questions for which they seek answers.

Research problem

Definition

A research problem is a question or matter involving doubt, uncertainty or difficulty that is proposed for solution or discussion Key aspects of a research problem.

or

A situation or circumstance that requires a solution to be described, explained, or predicted. It is an unsatisfactory situation that wants you to confront

Research Topic

The broad general area expected to investigate. It is a broad idea or concept from which many problems may be delineated.

- If there is a knowledge gap in an area that need to be investigated, the research problem identifies this gap. Where as the *research topic* is simply a broad area of interest, the *research problem* identifies what is problematic about that topic

Selecting a research problem

The ability to develop a good research problem is an important skill. When deciding a problem, there are a few things that you will need to do:

- brainstorm for ideas
- choose a problem that will enable you to read and understand the literature
- ensure that the problem is manageable and that material is available
- make a list of key words
- research and read more about your topic and finally formulate research problem.

Step 1: Brainstorm for ideas

- Choose a topic that interests you. Use the following questions to help generate problem ideas.

Are you interested in the Humanities; art, literature, music?

- Is there an aspect that you are interested in learning more about?
- Look at some of the following topically oriented Web sites and research sites for ideas.

Step 2: Read General Background Information

- Read a general encyclopedia article on the top two or three topics you are considering.
- Reading a broad summary enables you to get an overview of the problem and see how your idea relates to broader, narrower, and related issues.
- If you can't find an article on your problem, try using broader terms and ask for help from a librarian or change your selected problem.

step 3: Focus on Your problem

- Keep it manageable

A research problem will be very difficult to research if it is too broad.

One way to narrow a broad topic such as "motivation" is to limit your topic

Some common ways to limit a topic are:

- The extrinsic motivation

Step 4: Make a List of Useful Keywords

- Keep track of the words that are used to describe your topic.
- Look for words that best describe your topic
- Look for them in when reading encyclopedia articles and background and general information
- Find broader and narrower terms, synonyms, key concepts for key words to widen your search capabilities
- Make note of these words and use them later when searching databases and catalogs

Step 5: Research and Read More About Your Topic

- Use the key words you have gathered to research in the catalog, article databases, and Internet search engines. Find more information to help you answer your research question.

You will need to do some research and reading before you select your final topic.

After all that formulate a problem

Components of research topic

Effect of motivation on primary student achievement

- subject of study e.g. primary Student
- Variables

Independent

the variable whose effect you want to see.eg motivation

Dependent

the variable on which the effect should be seen e.g. achievement

- Relationship

Some examples

- Effect of visual aids on secondary school students academic achievement in chemistry
- Impact of physical facilities on elementary school students learning
- Effect of over crowded classes on elementary level school students learning.
- Effect of activity method on students academic achievement in math at primary level.

Consideration in selecting research problem

Expertise

Before selecting a research problem, you need to ensure that you met certain level of expertise in the area you are proposing.

- Make use of the facts you learned during the study and of course your research supervisors will lend a hand as well.
- Remember, you need to do most of the work yourself.

interest

- The most important criterion in selecting a research problem.
- The whole research process is normally time consuming and a lot of hard work is needed.
- If you choose a problem which does not greatly interest you, it would become difficult to keep up the motivation to write.

Data availability

- If your research title needs collection of information (journal, reports, proceedings) before finalizing the title, you need to make sure you have these materials available and in the relevant format.

Characteristics of research problem

New ways of thinking.

Leedy and Ormrod (2010) describe research as a process that should lead to thinking in new ways, or encourage further research in the field.

If the research problem does not contribute new knowledge to a field or topic it should not be considered research worthy.

The study must make advancements in the field and in some cases lead to explored ideas.

feasible

- It should be feasible (i.e. investigated without expending an undue amount of time,energy,or money).
- Should be feasible in terms of :
 - Time?
 - Place?
 - Money?
 - Equipment?
 - Subjects?

ethical

- It should be ethical. It will not involve **physical** or **psychological** harm or damage to human beings or to the natural or social environment of which they are a part)

significance

- It should be significant(i.e it is worth investigating because it will contribute important knowledge about the human condition)
- **Logical having sound rationale**

It should be logical and should have sound rationale.it should be based on through review of related literature to identify what has been done and what needs to be done.

clarity

- The research problem should be clear so that others can easily understand the nature of your problem.
- The research problem should have a single interpretation so that people cannot get distracted.
- The research problem should have to be free of any ambiguity

Well defined

- Well defined problem is half guarantee of a successful research.
- Sometimes researchers phrase the research problem in such a way that it gives a double impression.
- So the research problem should have to be well defined and well phrased it should have to be easy to understand.
- It should have a single meaning.

language

- The language of research problem should have to be simple. You should use technical terms only when it is necessary, otherwise use simple words so that everyone can understand it.

Novelty

It should be sufficiently original so that it does not involve objectionable duplication.

titling

- Research problem should follow the rules of titling.
- Like you can either use a sentence case or a title case but most of the titles follow the title case.
- Read the rules of titling before writing it down.

Current importance

current importance should also be the consideration of the researcher while selecting a research problem.

An obsolete problem will not be beneficial for anyone the problem should have current importance.

You should also assess how much the problem will provide benefit to the field in which you are conducting the study

thanks